

Natural England

To: Sarah Hollis, Senior Planning Officer, Millbrook District Council · Date: 2026-08-12

**Application MDC/2026/0412 – Land north of Millbrook (Ashcombe Farm and Hollins Farm):
solar farm of up to 85 MWp with battery storage**

Response: No objection subject to conditions

Natural England has no objection, subject to appropriate mitigation being secured.

We note the breeding bird survey recorded 23 skylark territories. The proposed 46 skylark plots on retained arable land and the five-year monitoring programme are appropriate, provided they are secured for the lifetime of the development through a Landscape and Ecological Management Plan (LEMP).

We welcome the predicted biodiversity net gain of 20 %, well above the statutory 10 %. The Biodiversity Gain Plan should show how the wildflower grassland will be established and managed to reach moderate condition.

Yours sincerely,

Natural England – Planning Liaison